

AI and the Future of the UCC Website

Dr. Kara Hosford



Understanding AI Usage Context

AI is viewed as an enabling tool

The public generally accepts AI-generated media as a pragmatic solution for grassroots organizations to produce high volumes of advocacy content on limited budgets (Dey, 2023).

UCC's international reach requires a nuanced approach

Cultural values shape trust and adoption, meaning AI integration faces varying levels of acceptance or resistance depending on regional context (AbuDaabes, 2025).



Current Challenges

Website users can struggle to find the right information quickly and confidently.

Key barriers on the current site:

- Accessibility gaps (WCAG 2.1 AA): missing alt text, uncaptioned videos, inaccessible documents
- Important content spread across disconnected pages and sections
- High effort required to move from general interest to the exact answer a user needs



Current Challenges: *Why This Persists*

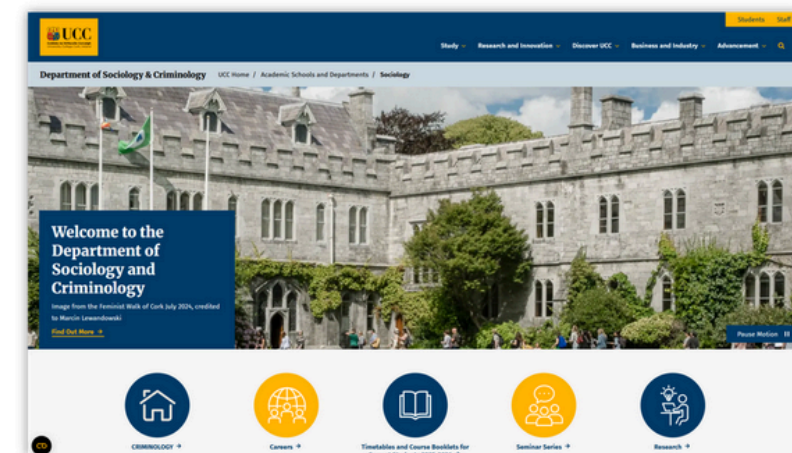
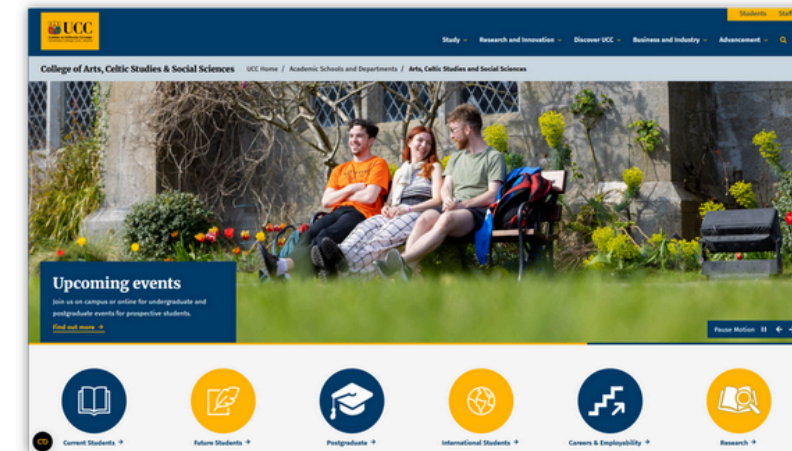
- Page publishers are operating under **time pressure** and competing priorities
- Legacy structures were built for **publishing pages**, not for answering user intent
- Navigation remains **hierarchy-first**, while user behavior is increasingly question-first
- As a result, users must **manually connect** information that should already be connected



From Structure to Discovery: AI Search for UCC

The current site is like an onion: a series of silos that forces users to peel through multiple layers to find what they need.

In contrast, The intent-based experience should be a 'starburst.' By using AI-driven metadata and relationship mapping, we can surface connected answers instantly. This moves us toward a dynamic, intent-based experience where natural-language queries provide a direct pathway to relevant content."



Ai isn't the Bandaaid Soloution

1. **Maintain HTML-first publishing** across units, with accessible Word/PDF only where necessary
2. **Apply consistent metadata and taxonomy** so pages are discoverable, linkable, and interpretable
3. **Embed accessibility standards in authoring:** headings, lists, tables, alt text, captions/transcripts, and plain language
4. **Support moderators through training and guidance** so standards are applied consistently in day-to-day publishing
5. **Review and improve continuously** to strengthen quality, compliance, and search reliability over time



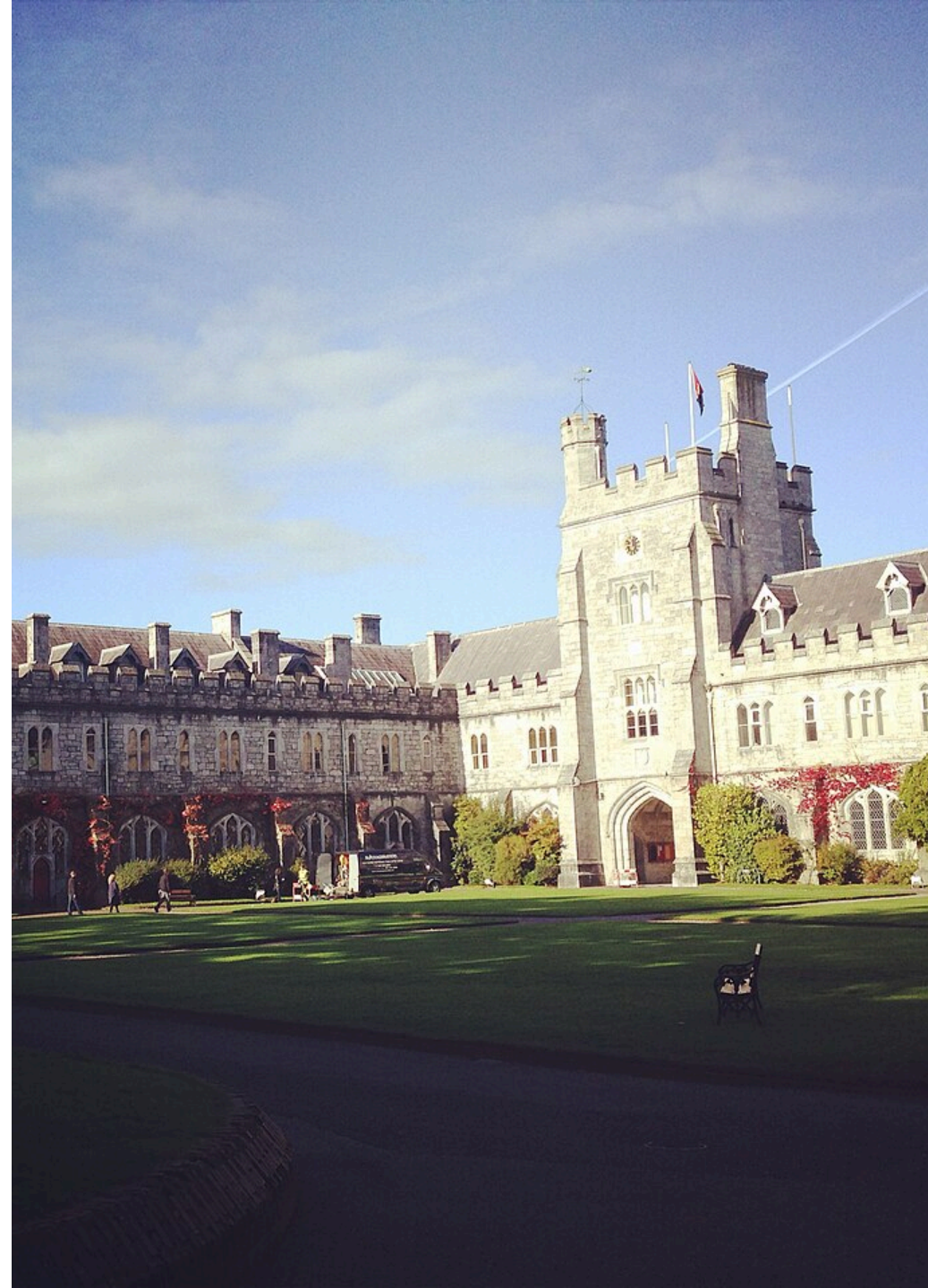
What This Means for the Web Content Editor Role

- **Operationalize standards:** turn accessibility and content rules into repeatable editorial workflows
- **Use AI with oversight:** apply AI to support tasks (alt text suggestions, transcript workflows, readability checks) with human sign-off
- **Improve discoverability:** strengthen metadata quality, internal linking, and taxonomy consistency across content types
- **Enable inclusive reach:** support multilingual and plain-language content for diverse audiences
- **Protect quality and brand:** maintain institutional voice, editorial accuracy, and governance accountability



Why This Approach Works for UCC

- AI should **augment** staff capability, not replace professional judgment
- UCC retains full editorial and governance **control**
- Human context remains essential for **quality, trust, and inclusivity**
- Institutional voice and brand **integrity** remains protected



How I Would Deliver in This Role

- Build and maintain an editorial SOP workflow that balances **speed, quality, and compliance**
- Evaluate and workshop trusted AI to support repetitive tasks (alt text, summaries, SEO/AEO metadata) while keeping **human sign-off**
- Prioritize **E-E-A-T principles** and **student-centered** journeys so users move from query to answer quickly
- Measure impact through **accessibility compliance**, engagement metrics, and content performance
- **Collaborate** across schools and services to keep the UCC voice consistent and trusted



Thank You

References

Dey, Neelam C. "'Unleashing the Power of Artificial Intelligence in Social Work: A New Frontier of Innovation'." Available at SSRN 4549622 (2023).

AbuDaabes, Ajayeb Salama, Hany Mamdouh Selim, and Rawa Hijazi. "From clicks to campus: how AI-powered digital marketing shapes student enrollment decisions." *Asia-Pacific Journal of Business Administration* (2025): 1-20.

